



Measuring festival quality and value affecting visitors' satisfaction and loyalty using a structural approach

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ABSTRACT

Perceived value is understood to be a precursor of customer satisfaction and loyalty and is itself impacted by product quality. The linkages between quality, value, satisfaction, and loyalty have been gaining increasing attention in the marketing field. Accordingly, this study examines whether quality dimensions have an impact on perceived value, which, in turn, affects satisfaction and loyalty, in the context of the Punggi Ginseng festival.

Application of the structural equation model indicates that festival quality dimensions such as program, souvenirs, food, and facilities affect value, which then contributes to visitors' satisfaction and loyalty. These findings contribute to the understanding of festival attendee behavior, providing researchers and practitioners with insights into how effectively to design a festival.

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1. Introduction

Festivals offer tremendous benefits to local communities because they significantly impact the local economy (Getz, 1993) and reinforce social cohesion within communities (Rao, 2001). This explains why festivals have been growing rapidly in quantity and diversity. For instance, communities have been hosting a variety of festivals in the pursuit of promoting local tourism and economies (Felsenstein and Fleischer, 2003). Furthermore, McKercher et al. (2006) pointed out that local festivals have been known to boost sustainable tourism by facilitating learning about unique cultural heritages, ethnic backgrounds, and local customs.

In the wake of such tangible and intangible benefits of festivals, the body of festival literature has been rapidly growing. Much conceptual and empirical research has been centered on economic impacts of festivals (e.g., Formica and Murrmann, 1998; Kim et al., 1998; Thrane, 2002) and the public's motivations in attending festivals (e.g., Crompton and McKay, 1997; Lee et al., 2004; Nicholson and Pearce, 2001). These studies have significantly contributed to the demonstration of the beneficial economic

impacts on the host communities and the design of festival programs and marketing campaigns tailored to visitors' motives, thereby facilitating subsequent studies on other issues relating to festivals.

Given that the economic impact of festivals is heavily determined by festival-goers' direct and indirect expenditures (Lee et al., 2007b), it is natural that a considerable amount of research has been undertaken on festival attendee motives. That is, the growing research interest in the economic impact of festivals has stimulated a parallel increase in the number of motivation studies on festivals. However, merely understanding visitor motives (e.g., escape, socialization, and cultural exploration) is insufficient to guarantee visitor satisfaction and loyalty; the comprehension of motives also needs to be factored into building attractive festival qualities and grasping the flow of festival visitor behavior (e.g., satisfaction and loyalty).

Baker and Crompton (2000) took the initiative in investigating relationships among festival quality, satisfaction, and behavioral intentions (or loyalty). Building on four dimensions of festival quality, they discovered that festival quality affected behavioral intentions (attitudinal loyalty to the festival and the willingness to pay more) more significantly than satisfaction. Recently, Lee et al. (2007b) conceptualized "festivalscape" as "the general atmosphere experienced by festival patrons" (p. 57) to look into festival quality. They conducted further research in which for the relationships between "festivalscape" and satisfaction, "festivalscape" and positive and negative emotions, positive and negative emotions and satisfaction, and satisfaction and loyalty. Still, little

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research focusing on post-attendance behavior has been compiled to enhance the understanding of what dimensions of festival quality affect post-visit perceptions (e.g., value, satisfaction, and revisit intention) the most (and least) from the perspective of festival attendees.

Perceived value has received a growing attention from marketing managers and researchers as one of the most influential predictors of customer satisfaction and loyalty (Cronin et al., 2000; Eggert and Ulaga, 2002; Parasuraman and Grewal, 2000; Wang et al., 2004). Perceived value not only affects customer choice behavior at the pre-purchase stage, but also influences customer satisfaction and intentions to recommend and repurchase during the post-purchase stage.

Some marketing literature indicates that product quality has an impact on perceived value, which, in turn, contributes to customer satisfaction and loyalty (Cronin et al., 2000; Parasuraman and Grewal, 2000). This implies that the linkages between quality, value, satisfaction, and loyalty are recognized as an important area of research. However, little research has examined the relationships among quality, value, satisfaction, and loyalty in the field of tourism, with festivals in particular. Accordingly, this study serves to propose a conceptual model of the relationships among quality, value, satisfaction, and loyalty (see Fig. 1) and tests whether quality dimensions affect perceived value, using a structural equation model in the context of the Punggi Ginseng festival in South Korea.

2. Literature review

2.1. Definition of festival quality

Crompton and Love (1995) took the first step toward investigating festival quality; they assessed predictive validity

for seven alternative quality operationalizations [expectations, performance, importance minus performance, performance minus expectations, importance times expectations, importance times performance, and importance times (performance minus expectations)] based on 22 festival quality attributes and suggested that performance-based operationalizations are the most valid measure. In contrast, the disconfirmation-based operationalization [e.g., performance minus expectations and importance times (performance minus expectations)] was discovered to be the least reliable measure. From the quality attributes developed by Crompton and Love (1995), Baker and Crompton (2000) later captured four dimensions of festival quality: generic features (festival characteristics), specific entertainment features, information sources (e.g., printed programs and information booths), and comfort amenities for festival visitors. They found that information sources and comfort amenities were hygiene factors, or a basic set of conditions, and that generic features and entertainment features strongly predicted behavioral intentions.

Relying on the concepts of performance quality and the quality of experiences (Brown, 1988), Crompton and Love (1995) also contributed to a fuller understanding of the distinction between quality and satisfaction. Quality of performance, referred to as “quality,” is conceptualized as service quality attributes under the direct control of a provider. On the other hand, the quality of experiences, termed “satisfaction,” is defined as an emotional state affected by both quality attributes and extraneous factors (e.g., mood and climate) experienced by visitors. That is, quality of performance derives from visitors’ perceptions of the provider’s performance, while quality of experience is an affective, psychological outcome of visitors’ experiences. Consistent with the prevailing perspective (e.g., Oliver, 1997; Parasuraman et al., 1994), festival quality has been used as a precursor to festival satisfaction (Baker and Crompton, 2000; Lee et al., 2007b).

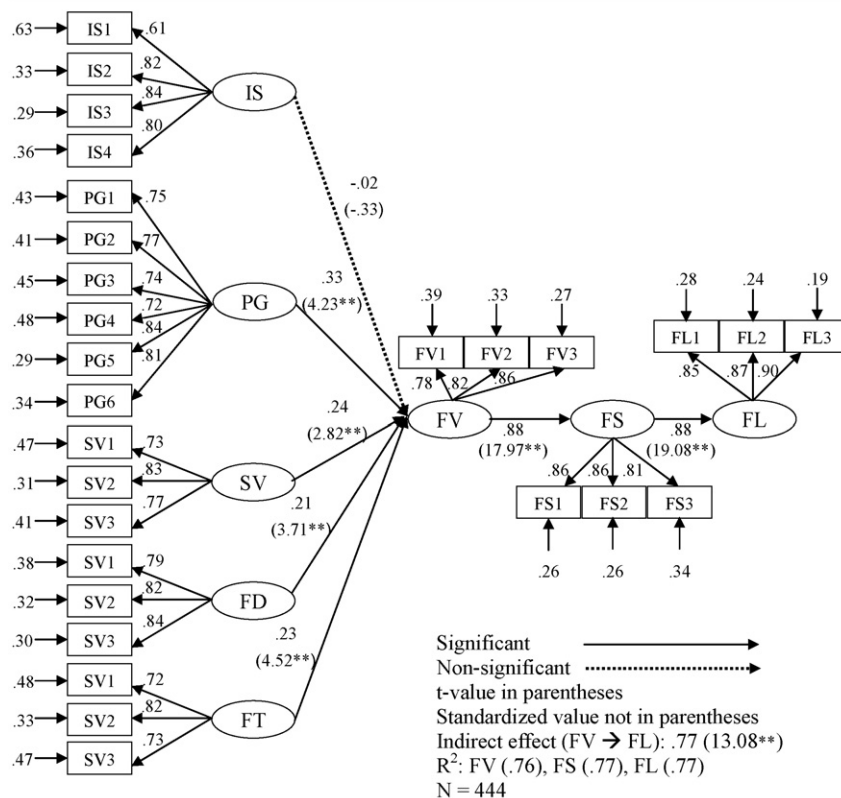


Fig. 1. Structural model testing. Note: IS (informational service), PG (program), SV (souvenir), FD (food), FT (facility), FV (festival value), FS (festival satisfaction), FL (festival loyalty). ** $p < .01$.

Moreover, building on “servicescape” (Bitner, 1992), Lee et al. (2007b) coined “festivalscape” in assessing the festival quality of the Andong Mask Dance festival. As stated by Bitner (1992), “servicescape” operationalizes the notion that physical surroundings (e.g., atmospherics, design) strongly affect consumer/employee behavior or satisfaction and establish a favorable image for service establishments. The concept of “servicescape” rests on three dimensions: (1) ambient conditions (e.g., temperature, air quality, music), (2) spatial layout and functionality (e.g., layout, furnishings), and (3) signs, symbols, and artifacts (e.g., signage, style of décor) (Bitner, 1992). Drawing on “servicescape,” Lee et al. (2007b) identified seven dimensions of “festivalscape” that may impact consumer satisfaction: program content, staff service, facilities, food, souvenirs, convenience, and information availability. They discovered that three dimensions (program content, facilities, and food) served as antecedents of festival satisfaction. Drawing on the aforementioned studies and previous festival survey results, the present study adopts five dimensions of festival quality: informational service, program, souvenirs, food, and facilities.

2.2. Definition of festival value and its relation to quality and satisfaction

We adopted the concept of value to elaborate on the path from quality to satisfaction. Various conceptions of value have been used by researchers (e.g., Dodds et al., 1991; Monroe, 1990; Zeithaml, 1988) in pursuit of a precise definition of this term. A frequently cited definition is that value is “the consumer’s overall assessment of the utility of a product based on perceptions of what is received and what is given” (Zeithaml, 1988, p. 14). Similarly, much of the literature has relied on the definition by Monroe (1990) and Dodds et al. (1991) that consumers determine value by mentally trading off between perceived quality or the benefit that they receive and their perceived monetary sacrifice. Their studies indicated that quality enhanced value, whereas monetary (e.g., price, traveling cost) and non-monetary sacrifices (e.g., time, efforts, search cost) diminished value. That is, as customers perceive more quality than sacrifice, they are likely to assess higher value. Quality has been widely described as the salient “get” (having benefits) characteristic (Heskett et al., 1990). In the context of festival dimensions such as informational service, program, souvenirs, food, and facilities (convenient parking lot, rest area, and clean restroom), as festival-goers perceive more “get” from the dimensions in return for sacrifice that they pay, festival value is more favorably assessed. This study thus posits that each quality dimension contributes to festival value as follows:

H_{1a}. Informational service is positively associated with festival value.

H_{1b}. Program is positively associated with festival value.

H_{1c}. Souvenirs are positively associated with festival value.

H_{1d}. Food is positively associated with festival value.

H_{1e}. Facilities are positively associated with festival value.

The importance of value has been manifested frequently in marketing and tourism literature, reflecting the fact that value is an antecedent of customer satisfaction, willingness to buy, repeat purchase, and brand loyalty (e.g., Grewal et al., 1998; Lee et al., 2007a; Oh, 2000; Petrick et al., 2001). For instance, McDougall and Levesque (2000) tested a model in which relationships were identified among value, satisfaction, and behavioral intention across four different types of service businesses (restaurant, dentist, hairstylist, and auto repair). Their findings showed that

perceived value has the largest impact on potential demand for restaurants, followed by auto repair, dentist, and hairstylist.

Lee et al. (2007a) explored the effects of three perceived values (functional, overall, and emotional values) on satisfaction of participants on tours of the Korean Demilitarized Zone (DMZ). All three values positively influenced tourist satisfaction in their study. The positive effect of value on satisfaction can be construed from the logic that value triggers satisfaction (Patterson and Spreng, 1997; Strandvik and Liljander, 1994). Specifically, value is conceptualized as a “cognitive-based construct which captures any benefit-sacrifice discrepancy in much the same way disconfirmation does for variations between expectations and perceived performance” (Patterson and Spreng, 1997, p. 421). In contrast to the cognitive-oriented value construct, satisfaction has been described as an affective-based construct (Oliver, 1997). According to seminal work in the social sciences, cognitive thought processes stimulate affective responses (Weiner, 1986), implying that satisfaction is a function of value. Thus,

H₂. Festival value is positively associated with festival satisfaction.

2.3. Definition of festival satisfaction

The prevailing definition of satisfaction is “the summary psychological state resulting when the emotion surrounding disconfirmed expectations is coupled with the consumer’s prior feelings about the consumption experience” (Oliver, 1981, p. 27). This definition lies in the concept of overall satisfaction. Anderson et al. (1994, p. 54) defined overall satisfaction as “an overall evaluation based on the total purchase and consumption experience with a good or service over time.” Spreng et al. (1996) further elaborated on overall satisfaction, stating that it has two precursors: attribute satisfaction and information satisfaction. They conceptualized attribute satisfaction as “the consumer’s subjective satisfaction judgment resulting from observations of attribute performance” (p. 17) and information satisfaction as “a subjective satisfaction judgment of the information used in choosing a product” (p. 18). Thus, it is important to know that overall satisfaction builds on the total consumer experience based upon both quality attributes and information (e.g., advertising, price) that are under the provider’s control. Festival satisfaction was operationalized as overall satisfaction since satisfaction in this study was based on overall festival value evaluated by the composite of quality dimensions.

2.4. Definition of festival loyalty and its relation to satisfaction

Behavioral intentions and (attitudinal) loyalty have been used interchangeably in the literature of marketing and tourism. Loyalty has been a crucial objective of service providers since the high retention of customers or a low defection rate determines long-term profit levels (Zeithaml et al., 1996). Loyalty or behavioral intention has been measured by (1) positive word-of-mouth, (2) recommendation to others, (3) repurchase intention, and (4) high tolerance for price premium (Cronin and Taylor, 1992; Zeithaml et al., 1996). The first three scales were adopted in this study to depict the traits of festival loyalty.

Numerous studies (e.g., Fornell et al., 1996; Getty and Thompson, 1994; McDougall and Levesque, 2000) have demonstrated the positive effect of satisfaction on loyalty. Satisfaction also acts as a positive antecedent to loyalty according to the literature on festivals (Baker and Crompton, 2000; Lee et al., 2007b). Oliver (1999) elaborated on the positive path from satisfaction to loyalty, stating that customer satisfaction positively revises attitude (e.g., a liking for the product/service) and that purchase intention is a consequence of a customer’s expected like

of the product/service. Specifically, such a revised attitude is the product of the cognitive comparison between anticipated satisfaction and immediate post-purchase satisfaction (Howard and Sheth, 1969). The positively revised attitude was found to increase the level of positive belief (i.e., belief confidence) (Albarracín and Wyer, 2000), to reinforce the level of positive affect (Oliver, 1997), and to enhance repurchase intentions (Yi, 1990). In consonance with this line of logic, once attendees are satisfied with a festival, their affective responses to the overall service/product experience favorably revise their attitude, which, in turn, induces the intent of repeat visitation. Hence, this study postulates that festival satisfaction predicts behavioral intentions (loyalty).

H₃. Festival satisfaction is positively associated with festival loyalty.

3. Methodology

3.1. Data collection

Since festivals are increasingly considered to be alternative tourism attractions and contributors to local economies, the Ministry of Culture and Tourism, Republic of Korea (MCT, 2006) has encouraged local festivals by providing funds as incentives and advertising on homepages of the MCT and the Korea Tourism Organization. Based on visitors' surveys and experts' evaluations, the MCT selects and funds prospective festivals. The Punggi Ginseng festival was funded in 2006, for example. It ran for five days from September 29th to October 3rd and attracted 620,000 visitors.

"Ginseng" refers to a species of *Panax*, which means "all-heal" in Greek (Wikipedia, 2007). The components of Korean ginseng help counter the effects of stress, increase protein synthesis and the activity of neurotransmitters in the brain, and stimulate the formation of blood vessels and improve blood circulation in the brain, thus improving memory and cognitive abilities (Phytochemicals, 2007). Ginseng is also used for diabetes, migraine, infections, radiation, and chemotherapy protection (Phytochemicals, 2007). Therefore, ginseng, found in teas, drinks, and functional foods such as steamed chicken soup, is popular among Koreans.

The onsite intercept survey was conducted on visitors who attended the Punggi Ginseng festival (for all of events) at the main exit to the festival so that a representative sample could be obtained during the weekdays and weekends. Furthermore, the same number of respondents was contacted every morning and afternoon throughout the festival in order to obtain a wide distribution of respondents. The field researchers approached visitors, outlined the purpose of the research project, and invited them to participate in the survey. After consenting, a self-administered questionnaire was given to those who preferred to complete the questionnaire on their own. Otherwise, the field researchers completed the questionnaire by means of a personal interview. Small gifts such as ginseng cookies or ginseng drinks were given to respondents who agreed to participate in the survey and completed the questionnaire.

Festival quality, value, satisfaction, and loyalty were measured on a seven-point Likert-type scale with the following values: 1 = strongly disagree, 4 = neutral, and 7 = strongly agree. A total of 477 questionnaires were collected from the survey, but after a thorough inspection, 33 questionnaires were eliminated from the analysis because important questions were left blank or checked twice. 444 questionnaires were therefore coded and analyzed.

3.2. Data analysis

The data analysis for testing the hypotheses in this study adapted a structural equation modeling (SEM) process which

empirically examined the structural relationships among the proposed constructs of festival quality, value, satisfaction, and loyalty. The three hypotheses were tested using a LISREL 8.30 while applying structural equation analysis and procedures suggested by Jöreskog and Sörbom (1999). As an estimation method for model evaluation and procedures, the maximum likelihood (ML) method (see in detail, Byrne, 1998; Mueller, 1996) and the two stage testing processes (recommended by Hair et al., 1998) were utilized.

SEM is designed to evaluate how well a proposed model or hypothetical construct explain collected data (Bollen, 1989a, 1989b; Hoyle, 1995; Yoon and Uysal, 2005). It also provides the ability to measure or specify the structural relationships among sets of unobserved variables, while describing the amount of unexplained variance (Byrne, 1998; Turner and Reisinger, 2001). According to Byrne (1998), SEM is "a statistical methodology that takes a confirmatory (i.e., hypothesis-testing) approach to the multivariate analysis of a structural theory bearing on some phenomenon" (p. 3). A structural model is used to hypothesize relationships among multiple variables or constructs. The processes in SEM are represented by a series of structural equations and relations that can be modeled pictorially to enable a clearer conceptualization of the theory under study. Thus, through the SEM procedure, the simultaneous examination and explanation of the pattern of a series of interrelated dependence relationships among a set of latent (unobserved) constructs are possible (Reisinger and Turner, 1999; Yoon and Uysal, 2005).

Clearly, the conceptual model in this study was designed to measure the structural relationships among the unobserved constructs that are set up on the basis of relevant theories and prior empirical research and results. Therefore, the SEM procedure is an appropriate method for testing the three hypotheses on the structural relationships among festival quality, value, satisfaction, and loyalty in this study.

3.3. Demographic characteristics of respondents

Table 1 presents a profile of the respondents. This table also shows respondents' profiles from 2004 and 2005 to see if the respondents of the current study are still a representative sample. The gender composition of the respondents in this study was 45.9%

Table 1
Demographic characteristics of respondents compared with past data.

	2006 (N = 443) (current study)	2005 ^a (N = 324)	2004 ^b (N = 382)
Gender			
Male	45.9%	48.3%	47.0%
Female	54.1	51.7	53.0
Age			
Under 20	.7	.3	.5
20–29	12.2	8.0	8.6
30–39	17.8	17.0	17.3
40–49	32.2	40.4	40.6
50 or more	37.2	34.3	33.0
Education level			
Elementary	1.4	1.2	1.3
Middle and high	42.7	42.9	39.5
College	17.6	20.4	18.9
University	32.9	31.2	36.1
Graduate	5.5	4.3	4.2
Marital status			
Single	17.3	12.3	11.8
Married	81.0	85.8	87.7
Other	1.7	1.9	.5

Note: Due to rounding some of the percents in this table don't total to 100.

^a Yeongju City (2005).

^b Yeongju City (2004).

Table 2
Goodness-of-fit indices.

	Chi-square (<i>df</i>)	RMSEA	RMSR	SRMR	GFI	NNFI	AGFI	CFI	IFI	RFI
CFA	842.33 (322)	.06	.07	.04	.90	.98	.90	.99	.99	.97
SEM	869.77 (333)	.06	.08	.04	.90	.98	.90	.98	.98	.97

RMSEA (root mean square error of approximation), RMSR (root mean square residual), SRMR (standardized RMR), GFI (goodness-of-fit index), NNFI (non-normed fit index), AGFI (adjusted GFI), CFI (comparative fit index), IFI (incremental fit index), and RFI (relative fit index).

male and 54.1% female. Their education level was mostly middle and high school diploma (42.7%) and bachelor's degree holders (32.9%). Most respondents were 40–49 years of age (32.2%) or over 50 (37.2%), reflecting the fact that mature participants were more likely to enjoy ginseng than younger generations. Respondents were also predominantly married (81.0%).

The sample of the current study appears to be similar to those of the 2004 and 2005 festivals in that the proportion of females was somewhat higher than males, the age groups 40–49 and over 50 constituted the majority, middle and high school graduates and bachelor's degree holders were dominant, and married people were predominant (Yeongju City, 2004, 2005).

3.4. Measures

The survey instrument (see Table 3) was derived from previous literature pertaining to festivals (Baker and Crompton, 2000; Crompton and Love, 1995; Lee et al., 2003; MCT, 2006; Yeongju City, 2005) and previous survey research done at the 2005 Punggi Ginseng festival. The survey instrument applied in this study has been officially used by MCT in order to evaluate over 50 different festivals in Korea. The validity and reliability of the survey instrument were tested using confirmatory factor analysis and Cronbach's alpha, respectively.

Additionally, this study adopted multi-measurement items for each construct to overcome the limitations of a single item; a single item is usually too specific to capture all the attributes of a construct and is likely to have a high rate of measurement error (Churchill, 1979). For instance, each quality construct was measured by 3–6 items (Baker and Crompton, 2000; Crompton and Love, 1995; Lee et al., 2007b). Measures for festival value, satisfaction and loyalty drew on the literature of consumer behavior and marketing (Dodds et al., 1991; Lee et al., 2007a; Oliver, 1997; Spreng et al., 1996; Zeithaml et al., 1996) with three items each. For example, festival value was measured by three items, such as 'the festival was worth what I spent (money, time, effort) on,' 'The festival offered more value than I expected,' and 'the festival offered more value than did other festivals.' Festival satisfaction was measured by three items, such as 'overall, I am satisfied with the festival,' 'as a whole, I am happy with the festival,' and 'I believe I did the right thing by attending the festival.' Lastly, festival loyalty was measured by three items, such as 'I will spread positive word-of-mouth about the festival,' 'I will keep attending the festival,' and 'I will recommend the festival to my friends and neighbors.' All items were measured on 7-point Likert-type scales, with anchors of "1" meaning strongly disagree and "7" meaning strongly agree.

4. Results

4.1. Testing for measurement and structural models, reliability, and validity

According to the goodness-of-fit indices (Table 2) from confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) and SEM, the proposed measurement/structural models were found to fit the data well. Since a Chi-square test is sensitive to sample size and the number

of indicators, this study relied on other indices in the testing models.

As shown in Table 3, the CFA results lend support to the convergent validity of measures, since estimated loadings for all indicators are significant at $p < .001$ (Anderson and Gerbing, 1988).

Also, the average variance extracted (AVE) (Table 4) for each construct was greater than the squared correlation coefficients for the corresponding inter-constructs, which confirms the discriminant validity (Fornell and Larcker, 1981). Table 4 presents the

Table 3
Results of confirmatory factor analysis.

Factors	Factor loading	t-value
Factor 1: Informational service (IS)		
IS 1 Pre-informational service enabled me to have a good knowledge of festival program and schedule.	.61	13.52
IS 2 Signage enhanced my understanding of information and direction.	.82	20.19
IS 3 Pamphlets were well prepared.	.84	21.08
IS 4 Festival staff provided good guide services.	.80	19.56
Factor 2: Program (PG)		
PG 1 Program was funny.	.75	18.11
PG 2 Program was varied.	.77	18.72
PG 3 Experiential program was wonderful.	.74	17.85
PG 4 I learned the culture of Punggi through the program.	.72	17.77
PG 5 Program was well managed.	.84	21.48
PG 6 Program was well organized.	.81	20.40
Factor 3: Souvenir (SV)		
SV 1 Souvenirs were varied.	.73	15.98
SV 2 Souvenirs were high quality.	.83	20.18
SV 3 Prices of souvenirs were reasonable.	.77	18.15
Factor 4: Food (FD)		
FD 1 Food was varied.	.79	18.89
FD 2 Food tasted good.	.82	20.24
FD 3 Food price was reasonable.	.84	20.64
Factor 5: Facility (FT)		
FT 1 Parking facility was convenient.	.72	16.19
FT 2 Rest area was well prepared.	.81	18.88
FT 3 Restroom was clean.	.74	16.78
Factor 6: Festival value (FV)		
FV 1 The festival was worth what I spent (money, time, effort).	.78	19.25
FV 2 The festival offered more value than expected.	.82	20.43
FV 3 The festival offered more value than did other festivals.	.85	21.83
Factor 7: Festival satisfaction (FS)		
FS 1 Overall, I am satisfied with the festival.	.86	22.27
FS 2 As a whole, I am happy with the festival.	.87	22.49
FS 3 I believe I did the right thing in attending the festival.	.81	20.35
Factor 8: Festival loyalty (FL)		
FL 1 I will spread positive word-of-mouth about the festival.	.85	21.75
FL 2 I will keep attending the festival.	.87	22.56
FL 3 I will recommend the festival to my friends and neighbors.	.90	24.09

All factor loadings are significant at $p < .001$.

Table 4

Correlations (squared correlation), reliability, AVE (average variance extracted), and mean.

	IS	PG	SV	FD	FT	FV	FS	FL
IS	1.00							
PG	.66 (.44)	1.00						
SV	.47 (.22)	.66 (.44)	1.00					
FD	.44 (.19)	.57 (.32)	.64 (.41)	1.00				
FT	.44 (.19)	.48 (.23)	.51 (.26)	.51 (.26)	1.00			
FV	.50 (.25)	.66 (.44)	.67 (.45)	.66 (.44)	.60 (.36)	1.00		
FS	.50 (.25)	.62 (.38)	.57 (.32)	.55 (.30)	.48 (.23)	.76 (.58)	1.00	
FL	.45 (.20)	.58 (.34)	.53 (.28)	.48 (.23)	.51 (.26)	.69 (.48)	.77 (.59)	1.00
Reliability	.85	.89	.81	.85	.79	.85	.88	.90
AVE	.60	.60	.60	.67	.58	.67	.72	.76
Mean	4.99	4.75	4.51	4.39	4.59	4.89	5.21	5.46
S.D.	1.33	1.17	1.16	1.28	1.35	1.16	1.09	1.19

IS (informational service), PG (program), SV (souvenir), FD (food), FT (facilities), FV (festival value), FS (festival satisfaction), FL (festival loyalty). All correlations are significant at $p < .01$.

Cronbach's alpha used to estimate the reliability of the multi-item sections: informational service (.85), program (.89), souvenirs (.81), food (.85), facilities (.79), value (.85), satisfaction (.88), and loyalty (.90). All of the alpha coefficients were above the conventional cut-off point of .70 (Nunnally, 1978), indicating an acceptable level of reliability for each construct. Additionally, construct reliability was further supported by the fact that all AVEs (see Table 4) exceeded .50 (Fornell and Larcker, 1981).

4.2. Hypothesis testing

As shown in Fig. 1, with respect to testing the relationships between festival quality dimensions and festival value, the contents of the festival program served as the strongest predictor of value ($\gamma_{12} = .33$, $t = 4.23$, $p < .01$), supporting H_{1b} . Souvenirs were also found to significantly affect value ($\gamma_{13} = .24$, $t = 2.82$, $p < .01$), supporting H_{1c} . Additionally, relationships between food and value (H_{1d}) and between facilities and value (H_{1e}) were supported in the results for the food-value path ($\gamma_{14} = .21$, $t = 3.71$, $p < .01$) and the facility-value path ($\gamma_{15} = .23$, $t = 4.52$, $p < .01$). However, informational service was not significantly related to value ($\gamma_{11} = -.02$, $t = -.33$, $p > .05$), indicating that H_{1a} was not supported.

As expected, festival value was positively associated with festival satisfaction ($\beta_{21} = .88$, $t = 17.97$, $p < .01$), supporting H_2 . Likewise, festival satisfaction positively affected festival loyalty ($\beta_{32} = .88$, $t = 19.08$, $p < .01$). Hence, H_3 was supported. Also, satisfaction was found to mediate the effect of value on loyalty, as indicated by a significant indirect effect ($\beta_{IE} = .77$, $t = 13.08$, $p < .01$) (Holland, 1988; Sobel, 1990). The mediating role of satisfaction reflected that festival value indirectly enhanced loyalty through satisfaction. The explained variance in endogenous constructs (Fig. 1) was 76% for value, 77% for satisfaction, and 77% for loyalty.

5. Discussions and conclusion

The model of festival attendee behavior was empirically tested using SEM. As the findings indicated, except for informational service, all the quality dimensions (program, souvenirs, food, and facilities) were positively related to festival value, which, in turn, indirectly improved festival loyalty via satisfaction. The festival program was the dimension most strongly associated with value, while souvenirs, food, and facilities similarly influenced value. Since festival value is a starting point in affecting loyalty via satisfaction, these four quality dimensions are presumed to be major contributors to festival loyalty. This claim has important implications for festival management.

The festival program was found to be the most significant antecedent of value. This finding corroborates earlier research. For example, Lee et al. (2007b) found that the festival program predicted positive emotion and satisfaction most strongly. This in turn increased festival loyalty. Additionally, Saleh and Ryan (1993), in their research on a jazz and handcrafts festivals, also discovered that program quality was the most crucial factor in attracting tourists to a festival.

The powerful impact of a festival program may be rooted in the hedonic attributes (e.g., fun, interesting, happy) in creating memorable experience. Gursoy et al. (2006) stated that people are motivated to visit festivals for exciting, funny, and pleasing experiences. Festival-goers normally undergo hedonic experiences from well-organized programs geared toward the needs of attendees. For instance, the organizing committee of the Punggi Ginseng festival has continually monitored and assessed the quality of the program over the past five years. The findings of quality assessment have led the organizer to improve the festival program and its products; in 2006, the festival offered a ginseng ritual, a ginseng contest, a demonstration of the cultivation of ginseng (with interpretation services), and other participatory events associated with ginseng. Especially, the organizer designed experiential programs (e.g., digging out ginseng from a field) that provided hedonic (exciting, delightful, funny) experiences for the visitors, thereby enhancing their value, satisfaction, and loyalty.

The effects of food and souvenirs on festival value are noteworthy since they were associated with ginseng as the festival's theme. Ginseng has been widely known as a medicinal plant, used in functional foods and Chinese medicine. The Ginseng festival and wine tourism have a commonality in that both are associated with food. Wine tourism has been triggered by tourists' interest in learning about wine and wine purchasing and by their health motivations (Mitchell et al., 2000). For example, Sparks (2007) found that "wine/food involvement" predicts tourists' intentions to visit a wine region. Similarly, food and souvenirs associated with ginseng can influence visitation to the Ginseng festival since many attendees are interested in learning about ginseng for health reasons. Authenticity has been used in explaining tourists' motivations, as they travel in pursuit of authentic experiences (MacCannell, 1976). In designing food and souvenirs for the Ginseng festival, the organizer therefore ensures that authenticity is attached to these experiences. For example, the Ginseng festival provides ginseng juice, ginseng fries, and a variety of foods associated with ginseng. Organizer has also developed souvenir ginseng candy, ginseng chocolate, and ginseng jelly. All ginseng-related foods and products are evaluated by the festival committee. If foods and products fail to meet a certain quality, the restaurant or shop will not be chosen by the committee in a following festival.

Facilities also positively affected value and enhanced repeat visitation intentions indirectly. This finding corroborates the results of Lee et al. (2007b). Their findings unveiled that festival facilities were found to indirectly enhance loyalty via satisfaction. Since parking lots, rest areas, and restrooms are major subjects of visitor complaints, the festival committee has improved these facilities by expanding rest areas and available parking space and staffing them with trained personnel. They have also increased the number of restrooms and provided for regular cleaning. All festival quality and performance aspects are evaluated by the committee and outside experts because these are criteria necessary for being selected by the MCT. Once a festival is selected, the MCT not only provides funds but also promotes the festival.

As with every business entity, festival loyalty is a principal goal for festival organizers in the sense that it guarantees market share and profitability. Loyal customers bring to a firm invaluable benefits: low incidence of switching to competitors, willingness to pay a price premium (Zeithaml et al., 1996), positive word-of-mouth (Boulding et al., 1993), and less cost to the company for retaining loyal consumers than engaging new ones (Reichheld, 1993). In the context of festival management, loyalty contributes not only to festivals themselves, but also to local communities. For instance, a well-known festival attracts a huge number of domestic and international tourists and thus generates significant economic impacts on the community (Thrane, 2002) through the creation of jobs and local taxes. Festivals also solidify a community's social cohesion because successful festivals enhance social and cultural identity by nurturing local ties (Rao, 2001).

Overall, our findings suggest that understanding post-visitation festival experiences enables organizers to more efficiently and effectively construct appealing events that promote repeat visitation; understanding post-visitation festival experiences: (1) increases understanding of the quality dimensions geared to the target market, (2) monitors value and satisfaction to revise the marketing mix accordingly, and (3) consequently increases repeat visitation or loyalty. However, the results may not be generalized to all types of festivals because sampling one festival in a cross-sectional study may lead to common method variance and sampling error (Dillman, 2000).

Given the current findings, subsequent studies are encouraged to further test festival visitors' behavior. For example, the conceptual model in this study can be explored from two different perspectives: first-time visitors and repeat visitors, given that they have been shown to exhibit different behavioral aspects in terms of motivational factors and satisfaction levels (Mohr et al., 1993). This multi-angle investigation is likely to capture a richer picture of festival post-visitation behaviors, thereby disclosing different paths from quality dimensions to loyalty by first-time visitors and repeat visitors. Further, Lee et al. (2007a) investigated the detailed effect of value on tourist satisfaction; items of value were divided into functional, emotional, and overall values. A future study examining the relationships among quality dimensions, the three types of values, and satisfaction would portray a more detailed picture of festival attendee behaviors.

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